

Philipp Hilbert. *AI Product Lead, Enterprise Knowledge & Workflow Automation.*

Positioning, 13 years owning AI and data products in regulated industries, now bringing that depth to Rakbank's Internal Productivity squad.

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Associate Vice President, Workflow Automation role at Rakbank. With thirteen years of product ownership in regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and fintech, I have spent most of that time doing exactly what the Internal Productivity squad needs: turning strategic intent into a working product, then persuading the organization to actually use it.

The enterprise knowledge engine is the part of this role I find most compelling. At the Federal Employment Agency I built the data platform that feeds national labour-market analytics to policymakers and researchers. That meant owning ETL migrations, introducing Dagster and dbt to remove manual hand-holding from quarterly imports, and integrating test automation into the Jenkins pipeline to free QA capacity. The underlying challenge, making institutional knowledge accessible, reliable, and fast, is structurally identical to what a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) knowledge engine does for a bank. I understand how the plumbing needs to be built before the search experience can be trusted.

AI democratization is the other half of the mandate, and it is where I have seen the most common failure mode: tools deployed, adoption flat, no one measuring why. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing developer workflows and discovered that the UI-led approach recorded exactly zero clicks. Redirecting to a code-first design doubled pipeline runs. That is the discipline I would apply to the bank's AI enablement program, playbooks grounded in observed behavior, not assumed preference, with measurable productivity gains as the success criterion rather than rollout headcount.

On squad leadership I have run a cross-functional team of fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum in a multinational programme, restructured an eighteen-person delivery organisation that was losing senior engineers back into three lean teams with their own leads, bringing attrition from near-total exodus to a single departure, and taken products from concept to production in domains with no precedent. I am comfortable being accountable for delivery, team health, and stakeholder trust simultaneously.

Banking is a regulated environment I respect: governance, information security, and risk alignment are not friction to be worked around but constraints that define what responsible delivery looks like. My background as Deputy IT Security Officer and my work inside EU AI Act governance discussions means I engage those functions as peers, not as gates.

I would be glad to discuss how my experience maps to the specific priorities of the AI Lab. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
